Sources

H 2080

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A. Background

The free-floating subdivision ***--Sources*** is used under historical topics, author-title and uniform title headings, certain types of literature headings, and headings for systems of law, for collections of writings such as documents, letters, etc., compiled for use by students, scholars, etc., in their research on the history of those topics, and for works discussing source materials of all types. It is also used under names of persons for works discussing the individual's sources

of ideas or inspiration for their endeavors or creative works and for collections of those source materials. This instruction sheet provides guidelines for assigning this subdivision.

LC practice: As stated in H 1075, LC catalogers will no longer use form subdivisions. For resources that would use form subdivisions, assign the LCGFT term appropriate to the genre and/or form of the resource in hand.

B. Recent revisions

2026-01: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.

C. Definitions

Sources: Collections of writings such as documents, letters, etc., compiled for use by students, scholars, etc.

D. History

Assign the free-floating subdivision ***--Sources*** under historical headings for collections or discussions of historical source materials. The subdivision ***--Sources*** is used directly after headings and subdivisions that denote history or a historical event or have an obvious historical connotation. The subdivision ***--History--Sources***, or ***--History--[period subdivision]--Sources*** is used after other headings to denote historical source materials. See H 1647 for instructions on use of the subdivision ***--History*** and a discussion of headings and subdivisions that are treated as inherently historical.

LC practice: For discussions of historical sources materials, use the general subdivision ***--Sources*** in conjunction with the appropriate topical subject headings. For collections of primary source materials, assign the appropriate subject headings for the topical focus of the resources. Also assign the LCGFT term(s) appropriate to the genre and/or form of the resource, e.g. LCGFT ***Primary sources*** or ***Notebooks***. If it is a compilation of different types of primary source materials, add ***Primary sources*** and, if appropriate, also assign more specific terms. If the resource contains many different types of genre and/or forms, including one or more databases, consider the needs of specificity according to *LCGFT Manual* J 110.

D.1. Collections

Assign the free-floating form subdivision ***--Sources*** as a form subdivision under historical headings for collections of contemporary writings or records, such as legal documents, letters, diaries, family papers, etc., assembled at a later time to serve as source materials for use by students, scholars, etc., in their study or research on the subject.

Examples:

Title: Human documents of Adam Smith's time.

651 #0 $a Great Britain $x Economic conditions $y 1760-1860 $v Sources.

651 #0 $a Great Britain $x Social conditions $y 18th century $v Sources.

LC practice:

651 #0 $a Great Britain $x Economic conditions $y 1760-1860.

651 #0 $a Great Britain $x Social conditions $y 18th century.

655 #7 $a Primary sources. $2 lcgft

655 #7 $a Excerpts. $2 lcgft

655 #7 $a Literature. $2 lcgft

655 #7 $a Illustrated works. $2 lcgft

Title: Documents illustrative of the Continental Reformation.

650 #0 $a Reformation $v Sources.

LC practice:

650 #0 $a Reformation.

655 #7 $a Primary sources. $2 lcgft

655 #7 $a Religious materials. $2 lcgft

655 #7 $a Records (Documents) $2 lcgft

Title: Dance as a theatre art : source readings in dance history from 1581 to the present.

650 #0 $a Dance $x History $v Sources.

LC practice:

650 #0 $a Dance $x History.

655 #7 $a Primary sources. $2 lcgft

655 #7 $a Essays. $2 lcgft

655 #7 $a Excerpts. $2 lcgft

Since the correspondence or diaries of an individual person may or may not be regarded as historical source material, depending on the viewpoint of the reader, do not add the subdivision ***--Sources*** or ***--History--Sources*** to the headings assigned to works of this type. See H 1480 or H 1538 for instructions on assigning headings to the correspondence or diaries of individuals.

For the assignment of headings to collections of government documents, see H 1643 sec. 6.

D.2. Discussions

Assign the free-floating topical subdivision ***--Sources*** under historical headings for discussions of historical source materials of all types, including written, visual, moving image, oral, etc., materials.

Example:

Title: A critical study of prehispanic source materials for the study of Philippine history.

651 #0 $a Philippines $x History $y To 1521 $x Sources.

LC practice:

No change.

Example:

Title: Sport--a guide to historical sources in the UK.

650 #0 $a Sports $z Great Britain $x History $x Sources.

LC practice:

No change.

Example:

Title: The sources of social and economic history of Rajasthan.

651 #0 $a Rajasthan (India) $x Social conditions $x Sources.

651 #0 $a Rajasthan (India) $x Economic conditions $x Sources.

LC practice:

651 #0 $a Rajasthan (India) $x Social conditions $x Sources.

651 #0 $a Rajasthan (India) $x Economic conditions $x Sources.

LC practice:

No change.

655 #7 $a Essays. $2 lcgft

E. Individual works

Assign the free-floating topical subdivision ***--Sources*** under author-title or uniform title headings for individual works in any field for discussions of the sources used by the author or authors in writing the work.

Examples:

630 00 $a Beowulf $x Sources.

```
630 00 $a Bible $x Sources.

600 10 $a Gibbon, Edward, $d 1737-1794. $t History of the decline
      and fall of the Roman Empire $x Sources.

600 10 $a Shakespeare, William, $d 1564-1616. $t Hamlet $x Sources.
```

LC practice:

No change.

F. Literature

F.1. General

Assign the free-floating topical subdivision ***--Sources*** under literatures, including individual genres, for discussions of sources of ideas or inspiration for these literary works, for example, ***English poetry--Early modern, 1500-1700--Sources***.

F.2. Individual literary authors

In accordance with H 1110, assign the free-floating subdivision ***--Sources*** under names of individual literary authors for works discussing the individual's sources of ideas or inspiration for their literary works and for collections of those source materials, for example, ***Shakespeare, William, 1564-1616--Sources***.

LC practice: For discussions of source materials, assign the subject heading ***[name of person]--Sources***, using the topical subdivision. For collections of source materials, assign the subject heading ***[name of person]*** and other appropriate subject headings. Also assign the LCGFT term appropriate to the genre and/or form of the resource, e.g. LCGFT ***Primary sources*** or ***Personal correspondence***. If the resource contains many different types of genre and/or forms, including one or more databases, consider the needs of specificity according to *LCGFT Manual* J 110.

G. Names of persons

In accordance with H 1110, assign the free-floating subdivision ***--Sources*** under names of persons for works discussing the individual's sources of ideas or inspiration for their endeavors or creative works, and for collections of those source materials.

LC practice: For discussions of source materials, assign the subject heading ***[name of person]--Sources***, using the topical subdivision. For collections of source materials, assign the subject heading ***[name of person]*** and other appropriate subject headings. Also assign the LCGFT term appropriate to the genre and/or form of the resource, e.g. LCGFT ***Primary sources*** or ***Personal correspondence***. If the resource contains many different types of genre and/or

forms, including one or more databases, consider the needs of specificity according to *LCGFT Manual* J 110.

Example:

Title: Artist on the witness stand.

[The artist, who works mostly in wood engravings, writes about his creative process. Also contains wood engravings by the artist.]

600 10 $a Eichenberg, Fritz, $d 1901-1990 $x Sources.

600 10 $a Eichenberg, Fritz, $d 1901-1990 $x Psychology.

LC practice:

No change.

655 #7 $a Wood engravings. $2 lcgft

655 #7 $a Autobiographies. $2 lcgft

Do not further subdivide headings of the type ***[name of person]--[topic]*** by ***--Sources*** or ***--History--Sources***. For collections of source material on a special topic about a person, assign a heading of the type ***[name of person]--[topic]***, and the additional topical headings required by H 1110, sec. 8, subdivided by ***--Sources***.

LC practice: See LC practice stated above.

Example:

Title: The great impeachment and trial of Andrew Johnson, president of the United States.

600 10 $a Johnson, Andrew, $d 1808-1875 $x Impeachment.

650 #0 $a Impeachments $z United States $x History $y 19th century $v Sources.

LC practice:

600 10 $a Johnson, Andrew, $d 1808-1875 $x Impeachment.

650 #0 $a Impeachments $z United States $x History $y 19th century.

655 #7 $a Trial and arbitral proceedings. $2 lcgft

H. Law

LC practice: For discussions of source materials, assign the appropriate subject headings for the topical focus of the discussion, using the free-floating topical subdivision ***--Sources***. For collections of source materials, assign appropriate subject headings for the topic of the collection. Also assign the LCGFT term appropriate to the genre and/or form of the resource, e.g. LCGFT ***Law materials*** or ***Legal instruments***. If the resource contains many different

types of genre and/or forms, including one or more databases, consider the needs of specificity according to *LCGFT Manual* J 110.

H.1. Systems of law

Assign the free-floating subdivision ***--Sources*** under systems of law for works containing historical documents such as acts, customs, court decisions and records, jurists' writings, etc., that led to the formation of a particular legal system, and for works discussing these documents.

LC practice: See LC practice stated above.

Examples:

```
650 #0 $a Canon law $v Sources.
650 #0 $a Islamic law $v Sources.
650 #0 $a Law $z Burma $v Sources.
650 #0 $a Law, Cherokee $v Sources.
```

LC practice:

```
650 #0 $a Canon law.
650 #0 $a Islamic law.
650 #0 $a Law $z Burma.
650 #0 $a Law, Cherokee.
655 #7 $a Primary sources. $2 lcgft
655 #7 $a Law materials. $2 lcgft
```

H.2. Legal topics

Assign the free-floating subdivision ***--Sources*** under headings of the type ***[legal topic]--History*** for collections and discussions of documents serving as source materials for the history of the topic. For collections, code ***--Sources*** $v; for discussions of sources, code ***--Sources*** $x.

LC practice: See LC practice stated above.

Examples:

```
650 #0 $a Feudal law $z Italy $x History $v Sources.
650 #0 $a Press law $z Uruguay $x History $x Sources.
650 #0 $a Educational law and legislation $z France $x History $x
      Sources.
```

```
650 #0 $a Slavery $x Law and legislation $z United States $x History
      $v Sources.
```

LC practice:

```
650 #0 $a Feudal law $z Italy $x History.
655 #7 $a Primary sources. $2 lcgft
655 #7 $a Law materials. $2 lcgft

650 #0 $a Slavery $x Law and legislation $z United States $x
      History.
655 #7 $a Primary sources. $2 lcgft
655 #7 $a Statutes and codes. $2 lcgft
```

I. Bibliographies and catalogs

I.1. Bibliographies

Assign the free-floating subdivision ***--Bibliography*** under headings of the type ***[topic]--Sources*** or ***[topic]--History--Sources*** for bibliographies of source materials on the topic.

LC practice: Assign the appropriate subject headings for the topical focus of the bibliography. Also assign the LCGFT term appropriate to the genre and/or form of the resource, e.g. LCGFT ***Bibliographies***.

Examples:

```
650 #0 $a Crusades $x Sources $v Bibliography.
650 #0 $a Technology $x History $x Sources $v Bibliography.
```

LC practice:

```
650 #0 $a Crusades $x Sources.
655 #7 $a Bibliographies. $2 lcgft

650 #0 $a Technology $x History $x Sources.
655 #7 $a Bibliographies. $2 lcgft
```

I.2. Catalogs

Assign the free-floating subdivision ***--Catalogs*** under headings of the type ***[*topic*]--Sources--Bibliography*** or ***[*topic*]--History--Sources--Bibliography*** for catalogs of individual collections of source materials. Assign additional headings, in accordance with the instructions in H 1361.

LC practice: Assign the appropriate subject headings for the topical focus of the catalog. Also assign the LCGFT term appropriate to the genre and/or form of the resource, e.g. LCGFT ***Catalogs***.

Example:

Title: Guide to the manuscript collections of Friends Historical Library of Swarthmore College.

650 #0 $a Society of Friends $z United States $x Manuscripts $v Catalogs.

650 #0 $a Society of Friends $z United States $x History $x Sources $v Bibliography $v Catalogs.

610 20 $a Friends Historical Library of Swarthmore College $v Catalogs.

LC practice:

650 #0 $a Society of Friends $z United States $x Manuscripts.

650 #0 $a Society of Friends $z United States $x History.

610 20 $a Friends Historical Library of Swarthmore College.

655 #7 $a Bibliographies. $2 lcgft

655 #7 $a Catalogs. $2 lcgft

J. Extended examples

Title: Akan people in Africa and the diaspora.

505 00 $t Volume 1. Akan cultural history: an overview / $r Kenya Shujaa -- $t History in the oral traditions of the Akan / $r Kwame Daaku -- $t History of the Gold Coast and Asante / $r Carl Christian Reindorf -- $t Oral historical case studies -- $t Iberian sources -- $t French and Dutch sources -- $t English sources -- $t Islamic sources.

650 #0 $a Akan (African people) $x History $v Sources.

650 #0 $a Akan (African people) $x Social conditions $v Sources.

650 #0 $a Akan (African people) $x Social life and customs $v Sources.

651 #0 $a Africa, West $x Social life and customs $v Sources.

650 #0 $a African diaspora $v Sources.

LC practice:

650 #0 $a Akan (African people) $x History.

650 #0 $a Akan (African people) $x Social conditions.

650 #0 $a Akan (African people) $x Social life and customs.

651 #0 $a Africa, West $x Social life and customs.

650 #0 $a African diaspora.

655 #7 $a Essays. $2 lcgft

Title: Land and labor, 1866-1867.

650 #0 $a Freed persons $z Southern States $x History $v Sources.

650 #0 $a Freed persons $z Southern States $x Economic conditions $v Sources.

650 #0 $a African Americans $x History $y 1863-1877 $v Sources.

650 #0 $a African Americans $x Land tenure $z Southern States $x History $y 19th century $v Sources.

650 #0 $a African Americans $x Employment $z Southern States $x History $y 19th century $v Sources.

651 #0 $a Southern States $x History $y 1865-1877 $v Sources

651 #0 $a Southern States $x Race relations $x History $y 19th century $v Sources.

651 #0 $a United States $x Race relations $x History $y 19th century $v Sources.

LC practice:

650 #0 $a Freed persons $z Southern States $x History.

650 #0 $a Freed persons $z Southern States $x Economic conditions.

650 #0 $a African Americans $x History $y 1863-1877.

650 #0 $a African Americans $x Land tenure $z Southern States $x History $y 19th century.

650 #0 $a African Americans $x Employment $z Southern States $x History $y 19th century.

651 #0 $a Southern States $x History $y 1865-1877

651 #0 $a Southern States $x Race relations $x History $y 19th century.

651 #0 $a United States $x Race relations $x History $y 19th century.

655 #7 $a Primary sources. $2 lcgft

655 #7 $a Essays. $2 lcgft

655 #7 $a Records (Documents) $2 lcgft

```
Title: Manifesto : a century of isms.
   650 #0 $a Civilization, Modern $y 20th century $v Sources.
   650 #0 $a Intellectual life $x History $y 20th century $v Sources.
   650 #0 $a Arts, Modern $y 20th century $v Sources.
   650 #0 $a Social movements $x History $y 20th century $v Sources.
   650 #0 $a Europe $x Civilization $y 20th century $v Sources.
   650 #0 $a America $x Civilization $y 20th century $v Sources.
```

LC practice:

```
   650 #0 $a Civilization, Modern $y 20th century.
   650 #0 $a Intellectual life $x History $y 20th century.
   650 #0 $a Arts, Modern $y 20th century.
   650 #0 $a Social movements $x History $y 20th century.
   650 #0 $a Europe $x Civilization $y 20th century.
   650 #0 $a America $x Civilization $y 20th century.
   655 #7 $a Primary sources. $2 lcgft
   655 #7 $a Essays. $2 lcgft
   655 #7 $a Excerpts. $2 lcgft
```

Revision history

2026-01: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.